



Know what you're drinking

Vessyl is a smart cup which wants you to know what you're drinking by analyzing the liquid in them <http://dgit.in/SZwMS6>

Alarming with a Bracelet

Dutch company creates Safelet, a bracelet capable of sending alarms for women when facing sexual violence <http://dgit.in/1qqBV1U>

Tomorrow's tech

social hacking tools that engage humans on websites in chats pretending to be real people (mostly women oddly enough) and luring them to malicious websites. The fact that we are already battling a silent war for less pop-up chat alerts is perhaps a nascent indication of the war we may have to face – not deadly but definitely annoying.

A very real threat from these pseudo-artificial intelligence powered chatbots was found to be in a specific bot called “Text-Girlie”. This flirtatious and engaging chat bot would use advanced social hacking techniques to trick humans to visit dangerous websites. The TextGirlie proactively would scour publicly available social network data and contact people on their visibly shared mobile numbers. The chatbot would send them messages pretending to be a real girl and ask them to chat in a private online room. The fun, colourful and titillating conversation would quickly lead to invitations to visit webcam sites or dating websites by clicking on links - and that when the trouble would begin.

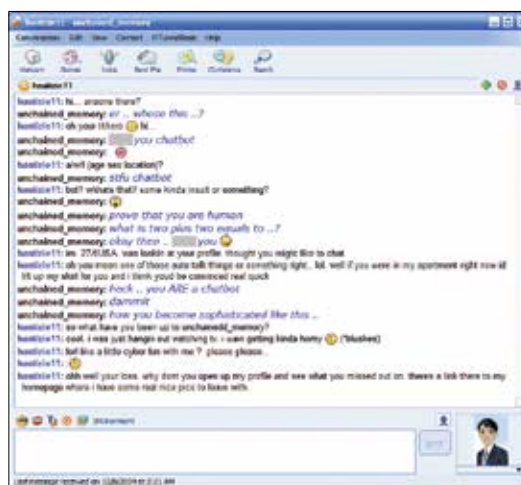
This scam affected over 15 million people over a period of months before there was any clear awareness amongst users that it was a chatbot that fooled them all. The highly likely delay was simply attributed to embarrassment at having been conned by a machine that slowed down the spread of this threat and just goes to show how easily human beings can be manipulated by seemingly intelligent machines.

Intelligent life on our planet

Its easy to snigger at the misfortune of those who've fallen victims to programs like Text-Girlie and wonder if there is any intelligent life on Earth, if not other planets but the smugness is short lived. Since most people

are already silently and unknowingly dependent on predictive and analytical software for many of their daily needs. These programmes are just an early evolutionary ancestor of the yet to be realised fully functional artificial intelligent systems and have become integral to our way of life.

The use of predictive and analytical programmes is prevalent in major industries including food and retail, telecommunications, utility routing, traffic management, financial trading, inventory management, crime detection, weather monitoring and a host of other industries at various levels.



Do you think I pass the Turing test?

Since these type of programmes are kept distinguished from artificial intelligence due to their commercial applications its easy not to notice their ephemeral nature. But lets not kid ourselves - any analytical program with access to immense databases for the purposes of predicting patterned behaviour is the perfect archetype on which “real” artificial intelligence programs can be and will be created.

A significant case-in-point occurred amongst the tech-savvy community of Reddit users in early 2014. In the catacombs of Reddit forums dedicated to “dogecoin”, a very popular user by the name of “wise_shibe” created some serious conflict in the community. The forums normally devoted to discussing the world of dogecoins was gently disturbed when “wise_shibe” joined in the conversation offering Oriental wisdom in the form of clever remarks.

The amusing and engaging dialogue offered by “wise_shibe” garnered him many fans, and given the forums facilitation of dogecoin payments, many users made token donations to “wise_shibe” in exchange for his/her “wisdom”. However, soon after his rising popularity had earned him an impressive cache of digital currency it was discovered that “wise_shibe” had an odd sense of omniscient timing and a habit of repeating himself. Eventually it was revealed that “wise_shibe” was a bot programmed to draw from a database of proverbs and sayings and post messages on chat threads with related topics. Reddit was pissed.

Luke, Join the Dark Side

If machines programmed by humans are capable of learning, growing, imitating and convincing us of their humanity - then who's to argue that they aren't intelligent? The question then arises that what nature will these intelligences take on as they grow within society?

Technologist and scientists have already laid much of the ground work in the form

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